Increasing New-Category Purchases on Blinkit



Team: Discovery & Growth

Collaborator: Vishal

Status: In Development

Problem Definition

- **What is the problem?**
  Most Blinkit users shop the same 2–3 habitual categories (milk, eggs, snacks) and never discover that the store also sells stationery, cleaning, personal care and electronics. Search only matches product names, so a user with a *need* ("study tonight", "movie night") has no way to find everything that fulfils it, and shopping stays a one-item errand.
- **Who is facing the problem?**
  The **See & Add Shoppers** – frequent Blinkit users who regularly purchase items on Blinkit and add items in addition to what they need, but whose baskets stay inside one or two categories. They trust Blinkit for speed, yet do not think of it for anything beyond staples. Their segments are detailed on the next pages.
- **What is the business value that will be unlocked by solving the problem?**
  1. **Potential Revenue Increase -** More categories per user means a higher basket value and better order contribution without raising the number of deliveries.
  2. **Cost Reduction -** Larger, more complete baskets spread the delivery and picking cost over more items, and fewer "forgot one thing" repeat orders are needed.
  3. **Catalog Utilisation -** Long-tail categories that sit idle in dark stores start to move, improving inventory turns.
- **How will the target users benefit if the problem is solved?**
  1. Users can describe what they need and instantly see everything that fulfils it.
  2. Users avoid the second order for the one forgotten item (bowl, spoon, notebook).
  3. Users learn the app can solve more of their day, which raises trust and stickiness.
- **Why is it urgent to solve this problem now?**
  Quick commerce is moving from "groceries in 10 minutes" to "anything in 10 minutes", and every player is widening the catalog. A wider catalog that users cannot discover only adds cost. Winning the habit of exploring new categories now decides who owns the wider basket later.

Goals

- Our goal is to increase **New-Category Items Added per User per Month**. To achieve this we need to increase:
  A. **Explorers** – the % of active users who add an item from a category they have never ordered from. It indicates the breadth of users engaging with discovery.
  B. **New-Category Items per Explorer** – reflects how complete each exploration becomes (bundle adds, planner adds).
  C. **Purchase rate of suggestions** – items added from a suggestion that survive to checkout.

  KPI TREE

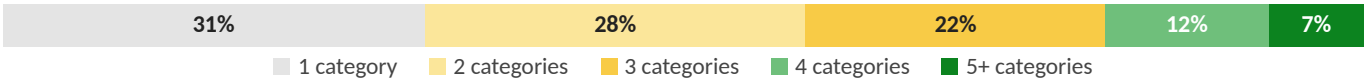
Non-Goals

As a part of the Discovery & Growth team we will **not** use monetary incentives (coupons, cashback, discounts, delivery-fee waivers) to push new categories, and we will not focus on catalog expansion or on metrics outside the KPI tree.

Validation of the problem

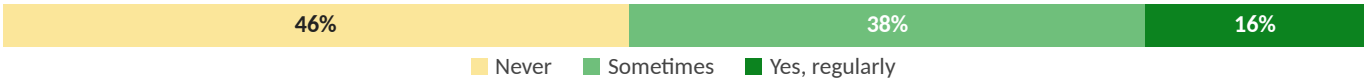
A survey was conducted which was responded by 50 people* and out of them 6 participated in 1:1 interviews as well. 78% were Millennials and GenZ; 70% were from Tier 1 cities.

How many categories do they shop from in a month?

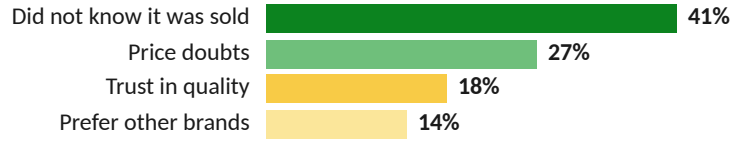


- 59% of users buy from only 1–2 categories = the "See & Add" pattern.

Do they browse non-grocery categories on Blinkit?



Why don't they shop new categories?



- More than 40% of users simply **did not know** a category existed on Blinkit.
- Users who add a milk or snack item rarely notice the related items (bowl, spoon, nuts) in other categories.
- Only 1 in 6 users says they browse non-grocery aisles on their own.

"I open Blinkit for milk and eggs. I never knew it sold notebooks until my kid needed one at 10 pm – I walked to a shop."

– Interview participant*

Most users do not search by product when they have a need, and they do not scroll to unfamiliar categories. They stay in the aisles they already know. **Problem Validated!**

**Survey figures are illustrative placeholders for the draft; replace with the final survey export.*

Understanding the target audience

Who?

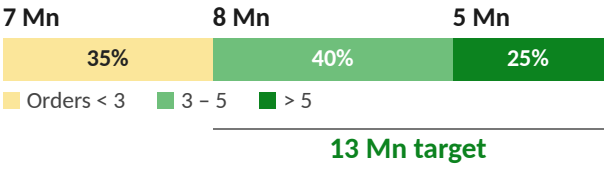
We will be targeting **Segment: See & Add Shoppers** – frequent Blinkit users who regularly purchase items on Blinkit and add items in addition to what they need.

Why?

Higher Impact Through Frequency	Existing Trust in the Platform
With more orders, even a small lift in the number of new categories per order adds up quickly, because each order is a fresh chance to show a suggestion.	Frequent users already trust Blinkit's speed and quality, so a suggestion to try a new category carries less risk than it does for a new or lapsing user.

Size

Assuming **MAU ≈ 20 Mn*** and users bucketed by monthly orders:



Assumptions
Orders < 3 / month = 35% users
Orders 3–5 / month = 40% users
Orders > 5 / month = 25% users

Key Personas





Ananya - 29 - Bengaluru - Product Designer	Rohit - 24 - Gurugram - Software Engineer
She orders milk, eggs and snacks four times a week and has never opened another aisle.	***He orders for the moment – movie night, guests, a deadline – and ends up forgetting half the list.***

"Even after ordering often, most users do not look beyond their usual aisles; 41% of the users in the survey said they did not know the category was sold"

Pain Points	Needs
• Searches only by product name; does not know what to type. • Forgets small add-ons (bowl, spoon, charger). • Places a second order for the forgotten item. • Does not trust unfamiliar categories at first sight.	• Type a need and see everything relevant. • A clear "what am I missing" prompt at the right moment. • One tap to add the full set. • Real product photos and a short, quick-to-scan list.

Other segments considered *(added to complete the analysis)*

Segment	Behaviour	Size*	Priority
See & Add Shoppers	Frequent Blinkit users who regularly purchase items on Blinkit and add items in addition to what they need	8 Mn	**Primary**
Occasion Planners	Order for events (study night, movie night, party) and under-buy	5 Mn	**Primary**
Staples-Only Regulars	Use Blinkit only for milk/eggs/bread, price-sensitive	Part of < 3 orders	Later
Offline-First Lifestyle Buyers	Buy stationery, personal care and gadgets in stores, low trust online	Part of < 3 orders	Later

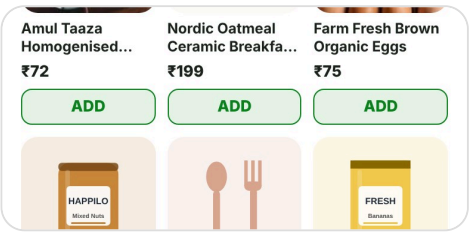
Solution

We hypothesised how to help users discover what a need requires, and selected the solution that meets them at the moment they add an item or describe a need.

See Appendix to view the solution selection

What?

Make It Complete – a need-led planner. Users can search by a need (sparkle "Needs" search), and whenever they add an item from the main screen a **blurred bottom sheet** suggests the specific items that finish the job ("Complete your muesli breakfast") with an **Add entire bundle** button.



Why?

- **User Research -** users do not know what to type for a need, and 41% did not know categories existed.
- **Previous Behaviour -** frequent users already accept "frequently bought together" prompts at cart level.
- **Market Trends -** assistants and intent-based search are becoming the default way to shop.

Impact

We aim to increase the users exploring a new category from **22% to 30% per month** and the new-category items per explorer without any monetary incentive. **Make It Complete**

Key Features

- **Need Search –** A sparkle "Needs" button in the search bar. Users type any need ("study", "movie night", "fever at home") and see grouped, relevant items. A local keyword search is the fallback if the smart search is unavailable.
- **Make It Complete bottom sheet –** After an item is added from the main screen, a blurred bottom sheet shows the specific bundle with item thumbnails (muesli → milk, bowl, eggs, nuts, spoon). Items can be added one by one or via **Add entire bundle**.
- **Need Planner page –** Every need has a page with a progress bar ("6 of 17 added") and an "Add all" action, so users see what is still missing.
- **Relevance rules –** The sheet does not reopen while it is open or for items added inside it, and it is never shown for items added from need search or a need page, since the user has already expressed the need.
- **Mobile-first shopping –** Real product photos, horizontal category tabs, a short scroll and a floating cart pill that stays reachable. Light and dark mode are supported.

Journeys

Journey 1 – Need-led

1	2	3	4	5
Opens app, taps sparkle Needs	Types "study"	Sees stationery, snacks, drinks grouped	Adds items; planner shows progress	Add all and View cart

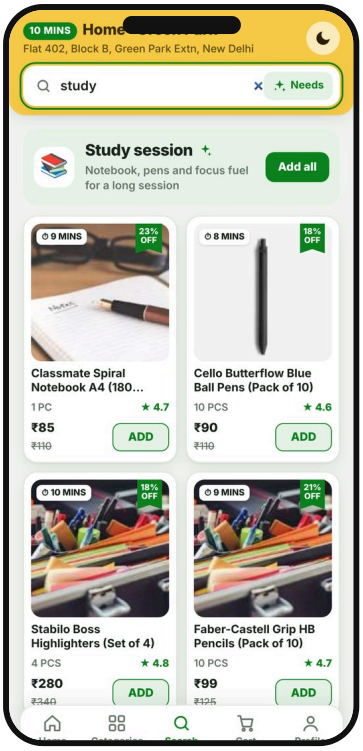
Journey 2 – Item-led

1	2	3	4	5
Adds muesli from the home screen	Blurred sheet: "Complete your muesli breakfast"	Sees milk, bowl, eggs, nuts, spoon	Taps Add entire bundle	Closes sheet, adds another item → new bundle

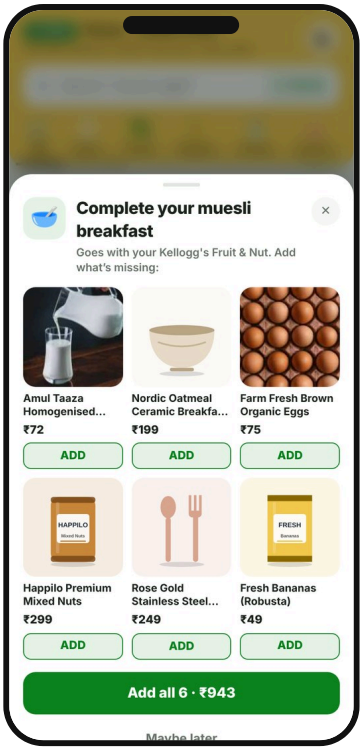
Design Principles

Principle	How it shows up
Specific, not generic	"Complete your muesli breakfast", never "You may also like".
Never loop	No new sheet while the current one is open; the next shows only after it is closed and a different item is added.
Respect intent	No nudge from need search or need pages. No "AI" wording – only the sparkle icon.
No money levers	Discovery is driven by relevance and convenience, not discounts.

Wireframes

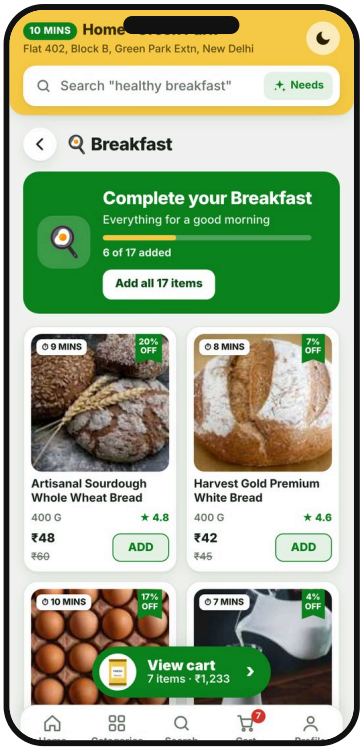


Need Search



Make It Complete Pop-up

[Live Prototype Link]



Need Planner Page

Key Metrics

North Star	• Avg. new-category items added per user per month
Awareness	• % of sessions using Need Search • Make It Complete sheet view rate (per eligible add)
Adoption	• % of users adding from a new category (Explorers) • Bundle add-rate and “Add entire bundle” taps • Need-page completion (items added ÷ items shown)
Customer Satisfaction	• NPS Score and sheet dismissal rate
Guardrails	• Checkout conversion and cart abandonment • Cancellations / refunds on suggested items • Orders per user and existing-category purchase rate

Tech Health Metrics

- Need-search response time (smart search and local fallback)
- Time to render the Make It Complete sheet
- Image load time for product thumbnails

Pre-requisite

- Percentage of catalog items mapped to needs and bundles
- Percentage of items with real product photos

Launch Readiness

Key Milestones (Estimated)

Phases	W1	W2	W3	W4	W5	W6	W7	W8	W9	W10
Design										
Data Collection										
Development										
QA										
Dogfooding										

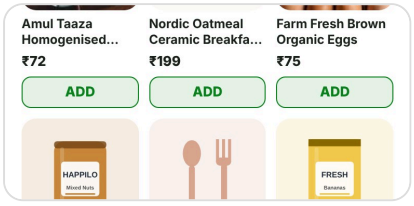
Dependent Stakeholders

1. Catalog & Category Team – need and bundle mapping, product photos; accuracy decides how relevant suggestions feel
2. Search & Ranking Team – Need Search integration and the fallback keyword search
3. Dark-store Operations – stock availability for bundled items
4. Support Team
5. Marketing Team

Go to Market Strategy

Pre-Launch

- **Store Target Strategy -** Start with dense dark stores in NCR and Bengaluru, where stock of long-tail categories is dependable.
- **Need Selection -** Launch with the five highest-frequency needs: breakfast, study, cleaning, movie night and party.
- **Bundle Quality Checks -** Review bundles for relevance and availability; a bundle with missing stock is hidden automatically.
- **In-app Education -** Banners and the sparkle icon explain “Search by need”. No coupons or cashback are used.



Post Launch

- **Metrics Tracking –** Track explorers and new-category items to confirm the goal and plan the roll-out to more cities.
- **Market Sentiment –** Review user feedback and the dismissal rate of the sheet.
- **Agility –** Use funnel analysis to add or retire needs and bundles.

Risks & Mitigation

Risk	Mitigation
Irrelevant bundles	Curated bundles for top needs; heuristic fallback by shared need and category; track sheet dismissals.
Nudge fatigue	No loops; one sheet at a time; no nudge from need search or need pages.
Smart-search latency / downtime	Debounced search with an instant local keyword fallback.
Cart inflation → cancellations	Guardrail on cancellations and refunds; “Add entire bundle” is optional and fully editable.
Stock-outs / missing photos	Hide unavailable items; use illustration fallback; photo coverage as a pre-requisite.

Appendix

Competitive Analysis

Common features such as search, ratings and cart are not added to this list

	Quick Commerce			*E-com*	*MVP*
	Blinkit	Zepto	Instamart	Amazon	MVP
Before Adding					
Category browsing & tabs	●	●	●	●	●
Search by product name	●	●	●	●	●
Search by need / context	○	○	○	●	●
Real-photo item thumbnails	●	●	●	●	●
While Adding					
Frequently-bought-together at cart	●	●	●	●	○
Specific named bundle (“Complete your muesli breakfast”)	○	○	○	○	●
Bundle shown in a blurred sheet at moment of add	○	○	○	○	●
Add entire bundle in one tap	○	○	○	○	●
Suppress repeated nudges (no loop)	○	○	○	○	●
Planning					
Need page with progress (“6 of 17 added”)	○	○	○	○	●
Add all items of a need	○	○	○	○	●
Need-led categories without monetary offers	○	○	○	○	●

Based on observation of public app behaviour; to be re-verified before circulation.

User Survey

A Survey was shared with 50 people* and 1:1 interviews were conducted with 6 people.

Who are they?

- 78% are Millennials and GenZ
- 70% are from Tier 1 cities
- 44% Female; 56% Male

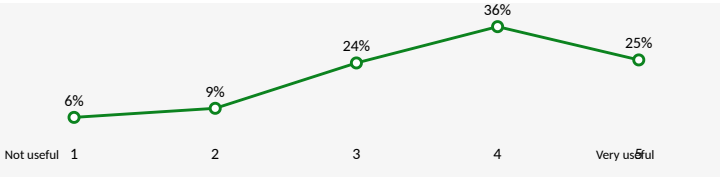
Where do they order groceries from?

- 42% prefer ordering from Blinkit
- 32% have used two or more quick-commerce apps in the last month
- 20% have tried a non-grocery item on Blinkit

- 26% say they have already used an assistant-style search while shopping elsewhere

What does the Target Segment feel about suggestions while adding an item?

- 61% say they would want a “what else do I need” prompt after adding
- 56% say they would tap it if it showed real photos



How useful would a “Complete your …” suggestion be? (1–5)

What does the Target Segment feel about searching by need?

- 64% do not know what exact product to type for a need
- 71% would try a search that understands “study”, “movie night” or “cold and cough”
- Both groups want to see everything for the need on one page
- 57% say they would add more if the list was short and photo-led
- Less than 10% say they would need a discount to try it

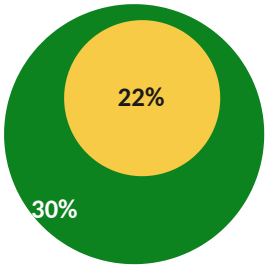
**Survey statistics are illustrative placeholders for the draft; replace with the final survey export.*

Impact Estimate

Segment Size – 13 Mn Users

Assumptions

- 22% of the target users currently explore a new category in a month
- 8 percentage points more will explore after this experiment



Target Users
13 Mn

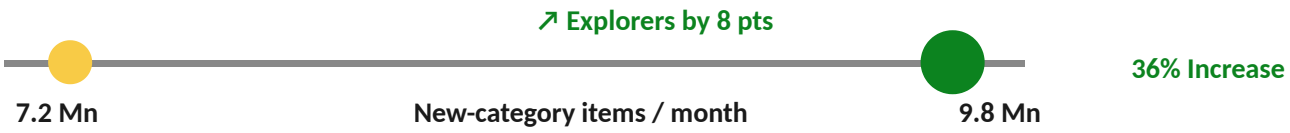
Current Explorers – 2.9 Mn

Potential Explorers – 3.9 Mn

No. of New-Category Items = No. of Explorers × New-Category Items per Explorer

Assumptions

- New-category items per explorer per month = 2.5 (kept flat; bundles should push it higher)
- Explorers = share of the 13 Mn target who add a new-category item that month



Moving explorers from 22% to 30% will increase new-category items per month by about 36%.

Selection of Solution

To solve the problem we need to help users discover categories they never open, without paying for it. We brainstormed 3 ways that can fill this gap:

1. Make It Complete

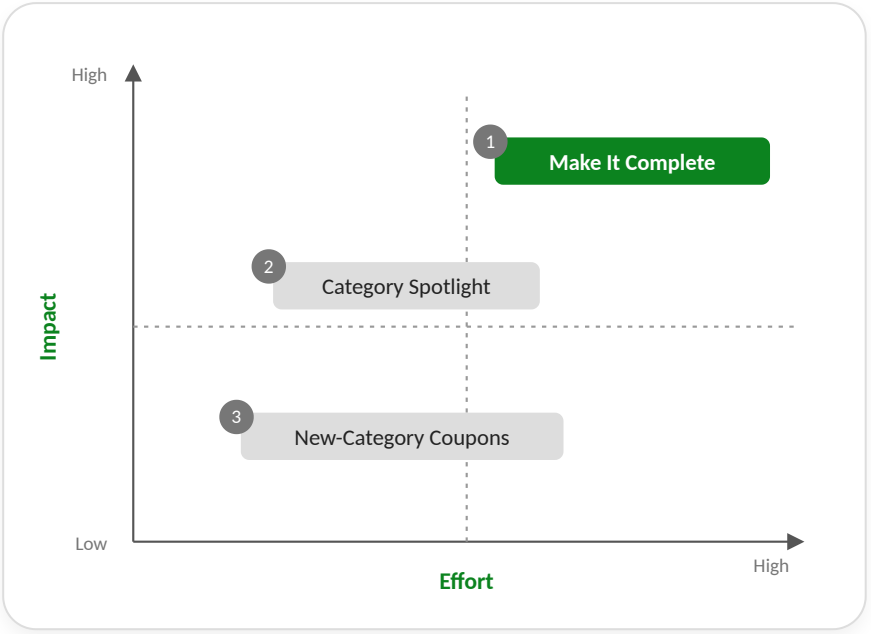
- Introducing “Make It Complete”, a need-led planner. Users can search by any need and, when they add an item, a bundle sheet shows exactly what finishes the job – for example muesli with milk, bowl, eggs, nuts and spoon – with a one-tap “Add entire bundle”. It meets users at the moment of intent, teaches them what the store sells, and works for every user without extra operations cost.

2. Category Spotlight

- Home-screen rows that promote under-used categories such as stationery or personal care. It is simple to build, but it relies on users scrolling to unfamiliar aisles, which the survey shows they do not do, and it is not tied to a need.

3. New-Category Coupons

- Offering discounts or cashback on the first purchase from a new category. It can move numbers quickly, but it is a monetary incentive and is out of scope; it also attracts one-time deal-seekers and erodes margin.



Based on the Impact – Effort analysis and our user research we plan to go ahead with the **Make It Complete Solution.**

How the problem space was identified

An AI discovery pass over public user voice (App Store and Play Store reviews, Reddit, X and YouTube comments) clustered complaints into opportunity areas. Mapping those to user segments pointed to one gap: users cannot find items for a need and do not know what other categories exist. This led to the product outcome above.

Inputs
Store reviews, Reddit, X, YouTube
▶
Opportunity areas
Discovery, forgotten items
▶
User segments
See & Add, Occasion Planners
▶
Product outcome
Make It Complete